

LOSERS in Charge

There is no revival formula in sight yet as the new party boss Nitin Gadkari shows his limitations and chooses a team that is far from being a fighting machine.

By Bhavna Vij-Aurora

The new leader was supposed to replace the creaky apparatus with a structure heralding change. Total overhaul—that was the expectation from the president of the BJP, arguably the most difficult job in Indian politics today. Binding himself with limitations of expanding without excluding, Nitin Gadkari left himself little room to manoeuvre. His focus in selecting his team was to blend youth and women power with

experience, while giving adequate representation to states and various sections of society. In his selection, which took him three months, Gadkari seems to have forgotten his own oft-repeated mantra of “performance audit”. All the losers and non-performers in the party have found their way into the organisation as office bearers. He has settled for the tired and the tested. Vinay Katiyar, earlier general secretary and now vice-president, has the dubious distinction of losing four Lok Sabha

elections in a row from four different constituencies. Mukhtar Abbas Naqvi lost all the last three elections—including his deposit—he contested.

The other Muslim face of the party, three-time MP Shahnawaz Hussain, who was also Union cabinet minister of civil aviation, had to content himself with the post of one of the six spokespersons for the party. While Ravi Shankar Prasad, a Rajya Sabha member and former minister of state for information and broadcasting, was designated chief

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**BJP PRESIDENT
NITIN GADKARI**

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